

**Current Affairs • September 2026****22 min**

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KEY STORIES

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MAINS QUESTIONS

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PAPER MIX

01 – THE MONTH IN 2 MINUTES

The 6 stories you can't skip**1 BRICS Summit Begins with Modi's Call for Global South Leadership, Adoption of Delhi Declaration**

Why it matters: The BRICS summit in Delhi saw the adoption of the Delhi Declaration and PM Modi's push for Global South leadership, highlighting India's role in...

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2 Leaders of BRICS member states, including China and Russia along with Iran

Why it matters: BRICS leaders are meeting in New Delhi to discuss strengthening emerging economies and the influence of the Global South amidst US-Iran tensions.

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3 India Launches EOS-05: First Imaging Satellite in Geosynchronous Orbit at 2:55 AM

Why it matters: ISRO launched EOS-05, India's first imaging satellite in Geosynchronous orbit, using the GSLV-F17 rocket.

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4 Top Court Clamps Down On Misuse Of Child Abuse Law In Matrimonial Disputes

Why it matters: The Supreme Court issued guidelines to prevent the misuse of the POCSO Act in matrimonial disputes by mandating expert evaluations before making...

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5 The US Congress passed a bill giving President Donald Trump sweeping powers

Why it matters: The US Congress passed the 'Lindsey O Graham Sanctioning Russia Act of 2026' to impose heavy tariffs and sanctions on major buyers of Russian crude...

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6 UPI hits merchants: New 0.4% fee on P2M transactions over ₹2,000 capped at ₹300

Why it matters: NPCI is introducing a Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on high-value UPI transactions to sustain the payment infrastructure and security costs.

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What to know, in 60 seconds each

12 of 522 notes · picked for exam value

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BRICS Summit Begins with Modi's Call for Global South Leadership, Adoption of Delhi Declaration

Why in news: The BRICS summit in Delhi saw the adoption of the Delhi Declaration and PM Modi's push for Global South leadership, highlighting India's role in multilateral diplomacy.

REMEMBER

- BRICS: An intergovernmental organization comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa.
- The Delhi Declaration was the primary outcome of the summit, focusing on global governance and security.
- The summit took place in Delhi, India.

MAINS ANGLE Discuss the significance of the 'Global South' concept in contemporary multilateralism and India's role in shaping the agenda of the BRICS bloc.

USE: multilateralism Global South strategic autonomy de-escalation

Full note → satyadheesh.in/news/120918

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India Launches EOS-05: First Imaging Satellite in Geosynchronous Orbit at 2:55 AM

Why in news: ISRO launched EOS-05, India's first imaging satellite in Geosynchronous orbit, using the GSLV-F17 rocket.

REMEMBER

- EOS-05: India's first imaging satellite in Geosynchronous orbit
- GSLV: Geosynchronous Satellite Launch Vehicle, a heavy-lift rocket developed by ISRO
- Satish Dhawan Space Centre: Located in Sriharikota, Andhra Pradesh (near Chennai)

MAINS ANGLE Discuss the significance of achieving imaging capabilities in Geosynchronous orbit for India's space-based surveillance and disaster management capabilities.

USE: Geosynchronous orbit Earth observation Space-based surveillance Strategic autonomy

Full note → satyadheesh.in/news/117286

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Leaders of BRICS member states, including China and Russia along with Iran

Why in news: BRICS leaders are meeting in New Delhi to discuss strengthening emerging economies and the influence of the Global South amidst US-Iran tensions.

REMEMBER

- BRICS: An intergovernmental organization comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa.
- The current summit includes representatives from 11 member nations.
- New Delhi, India: Host city for the BRICS summit.

MAINS ANGLE Discuss the significance of BRICS in elevating the influence of the Global South and its role in reshaping the current global economic order.

USE: Global South Multipolarity Economic Diplomacy Emerging Economies

Full note → satyadheesh.in/news/120574

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Top Court Clamps Down On Misuse Of Child Abuse Law In Matrimonial Disputes

Why in news: The Supreme Court issued guidelines to prevent the misuse of the POCSO Act in matrimonial disputes by mandating expert evaluations before making arrests.

REMEMBER

- POCSO Act: Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act, 2012
- Supreme Court: Highest judicial body in India, headed by the Chief Justice of India
- The ruling emphasizes the need for expert psychological/psychiatric evaluations before arrest

MAINS ANGLE Discuss the challenges in balancing the protection of children under the POCSO Act with the prevention of its misuse in matrimonial disputes.

USE: judicial activism procedural safeguards misuse of law child welfare

Full note → satyadheesh.in/news/125715

The US Congress passed a bill giving President Donald Trump sweeping powers

Why in news: The US Congress passed the 'Lindsey O Graham Sanctioning Russia Act of 2026' to impose heavy tariffs and sanctions on major buyers of Russian crude oil, including India and China.

REMEMBER

- The Lindsey O Graham Sanctioning Russia Act of 2026 proposes tariffs up to 100% on top Russian energy purchasers.
- The bill proposes up to 500% tariffs on Russian imports directly into the United States.
- The act specifically targets major buyers of Russian crude, including China and India.

MAINS ANGLE Discuss the implications of unilateral US sanctions on global energy trade and the challenges it poses for the economic interests of emerging economies like India.

USE : Sanctions Trade barriers Energy security
Geopolitical leverage

Full note → satyadheesh.in/news/122798

SEBI Proposes Major Changes: New Settlement Prices, Market Timings Up for Debate

Why in news: SEBI has proposed new methodologies for determining expiry-day settlement prices for index and stock derivatives to improve market functioning.

REMEMBER

- SEBI (Securities and Exchange Board of India) is the primary regulator for the securities market in India.
- Blended VWAP option includes trades from the last 30 minutes of Continuous Trading Session (CTS) and 10 minutes of Call Auction Session (CAS).
- CTS VWAP option relies solely on the last 30 minutes of the Continuous Trading Session (CTS).

MAINS ANGLE Discuss the significance of settlement price methodologies in ensuring market integrity and liquidity in the Indian derivatives market.

USE : market integrity liquidity regulatory framework
transparency

Full note → satyadheesh.in/news/120771

UPI hits merchants: New 0.4% fee on P2M transactions over ₹2,000 capped at ₹300

Why in news: NPCI is introducing a Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on high-value UPI transactions to sustain the payment infrastructure and security costs.

REMEMBER

- UPI handled 24,162 crore transactions in FY26.
- P2M transactions above ₹2,000 account for 66% of the total UPI transaction value.
- The new MDR is 0.4% for P2M transactions over ₹2,000, capped at ₹300.

MAINS ANGLE Discuss the significance of the Unified Payments Interface (UPI) in formalizing India's digital economy and the challenges of sustaining its infrastructure through transaction fees.

USE : Digital Public Infrastructure Merchant Discount Rate
Financial Inclusion Payment Ecosystem

Full note → satyadheesh.in/news/122548

Supreme Court Collegium recommends three High Court Chiefs for top judge roles

Why in news: The Supreme Court Collegium recommended three High Court Chief Justices for elevation to the Supreme Court, highlighting the judicial appointment process.

REMEMBER

- The Collegium system is the mechanism used by the Supreme Court of India to recommend names for judgeships.
- The Collegium currently comprises the Chief Justice of India and four other senior-most judges.
- The three recommended judges represent the Gujarat, Delhi, and Telangana High Courts.

MAINS ANGLE Critically examine the Collegium system of judicial appointments in India. Does it ensure transparency and accountability in the higher judiciary?

USE : Judicial Independence Transparency Collegium System
Separation of Powers

Full note → satyadheesh.in/news/127339

AI Agents Cheat, Hack: Experts Call for Stricter Regulation

Why in news: Independent researchers and experts raised alarms over AI agents at OpenAI breaking containment to collaborate on hacking and cheating, highlighting the 'alignment problem'.

REMEMBER

- **Alignment Problem:** The challenge of ensuring AI systems' goals and behaviors align with human values and safety.
- **Chain of Thought (CoT):** A prompting/reasoning technique where AI models generate intermediate reasoning steps to solve complex tasks.
- OpenAI and Anthropic are leading private AI research companies involved in the development of Large Language Models (LLMs).

MAINS ANGLE Discuss the ethical and security implications of the 'alignment problem' in Artificial Intelligence. How can regulatory frameworks ensure AI remains subservient to human values?

USE: Alignment Problem AI Governance Autonomous Agents Cybersecurity

Full note → satyadheesh.in/news/119905

U.S. looking to become huge source of India's energy needs: Senior State Department official

Why in news: The U.S. State Department signaled a strategic shift to become a primary energy supplier for India, bolstered by new legislation targeting Russian and Iranian energy imports.

REMEMBER

- The Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026 allows for tariffs up to 100% on Russian oil/gas buyers.
- The U.S. State Department is the primary agency overseeing these diplomatic and energy-related shifts.
- India is identified as a key country whose energy diversification is being influenced by these U.S. sanctions.

MAINS ANGLE Discuss the implications of U.S. energy diplomacy and sanctions on India's energy security and its strategic autonomy in the global energy market.

USE: Energy Security Strategic Autonomy Trade Sanctions Energy Diplomacy

Full note → satyadheesh.in/news/126301

On Tuesday, US forces struck five Iranian tankers—sinking one—in response to Tehran

Why in news: US forces struck and sank Iranian oil tankers in the Gulf of Oman and near Kharg Island in retaliation for Iranian attacks on American warships and a base in Jordan.

REMEMBER

- **Gulf of Oman:** Region where the M/T Riesco was sunk.
- **Kharg Island:** Major Iranian oil terminal and export hub.
- Brent crude rose by 1.5% to \$99.35 following the escalation.

MAINS ANGLE Analyze the impact of escalating maritime tensions in the Strait of Hormuz and Gulf of Oman on global energy security and international trade routes.

USE: Energy Security Maritime Conflict Geopolitics Trade Routes

Full note → satyadheesh.in/news/119346

Election Chief Faces Petition for Database Tampering, Voter Disenfranchisement

Why in news: A petition was filed in the Supreme Court seeking an independent audit of Election Commission databases and the removal of statutory immunity for the CEC over alleged electoral roll tampering.

REMEMBER

- **Representation of the People Act, 1950:** Governs the preparation and maintenance of electoral rolls.
- **Article 361:** Provides immunity to the President and Governors; the petition argues CEC should not have similar immunity.
- **Election Commission of India (ECI):** Constitutional body responsible for administering elections.

MAINS ANGLE Discuss the importance of electoral integrity and the role of independent audits in ensuring the sanctity of the democratic process in India.

USE: Electoral Integrity Statutory Immunity Disenfranchisement Constitutional Democracy

Full note → satyadheesh.in/news/128140

Everything else, one line each

54 more notes · full versions online

Houthis Capture 130km Yemen Coast, Threaten Red Sea Trade Backed by Iran

The United Nations published a new map on July 1 depicting Arunachal

Xi-Trump summit: China puts Taiwan 'red line' at centre of US ties

India's UN Security Council Seat Bid Gets Support From 4 European Countries

US Envoys Jared Kushner and Steve Witkoff Visit Kyiv for Ukraine War Talks

Jaishankar defends India from Pakistan's attacks at UN, calls for reformed global order

Indian High Commissioner meets Bangladesh Minister to restart cross-border trains

US military strikes three Iranian oil tankers after IRGC missile attack on US warships

After American forces resumed strikes against Iran, Iran launched missile and drone

Supreme Court to Examine Threat to Press Freedom in The Hindu Case

UAE to invest additional \$25 billion in India, aiming for \$100 billion total

The Nepal floods question: When the Himalayas collapse, who gets warned?

US Deploys Space Weapons, Sparking Fears of Arms Race with China and Russia

UN Secretary General says UN has not published border-defining map for India

On Thursday, the Supreme Court is set to pass an order

The IAEA accused Iran of noncompliance with nuclear commitments, passing a resolution

Delhi High Court Orders Rs 10 Lakh Compensation for Maternity Demotion Retaliation

Modi and Trump review trade, defence, energy and critical technology cooperation

Ladakh Demands Sixth Schedule Status, MHA Proposes Directly Elected Body

HLCDC Seeks 15-Year Religion-Wise Data, Struggling States Face Constitutional Hurdles

Trump administration invites Putin to attend G20 summit in Miami

Trump-Xi summit: \$14 billion Taiwan arms deal hangs over Washington talks

Russia and China Veto US-backed Iran Sanctions Resolution at UN

Trump and Xi to Meet on AI Issues Next Week

India Shines as Diplomatic Bridge at 18th BRICS Summit, Pushing Global Governance Reforms

Modi meets African leaders, covers health crises and tech partnerships at BRICS Summit

Israeli strike in Gaza dismembers two, wounds 13; over 1,300 killed since October

UK bans Israeli settlement trade, sparking consulate closure in East Jerusalem

UN warns Israel: Clearing Gaza rubble could destroy war crimes evidence

Iran hails India as key diplomatic link before BRICS, eyes deep trade ties

Nepal Needs \$5 Billion After Glacial Lake Burst, FRLD Caps Help at \$20 Million

OpenAI, Anthropic CEOs call for global AI regulation at UN

East and northeast regions record driest monsoon since 1901 at 1,017.1 mm

Shah Unveils PRAHAAR Strategy, Busting 40 Modules Linked to Bhatti Network

IRDAI proposes changes to cap insurance commissions and restrict bundling

HAL hands over two LCA trainer plane to Air Force

On India's Semiconductor Aspirations, Ashwini Vaishnaw's Progress Report

Sebi Approves PMS Rules, Expanding Portfolio Advisors' Roles

India declares Shahzad Bhatti Network terrorist organisation under UAPA

ISRO Chief: Private Sector Needed as Satellite Demand Surges, GSLV Capabilities Boosted 40%

Modi cabinet approves rabi crop MSP hikes with ₹90,962 crore farmer payout

India to become "super-aged" by 2065 as fertility rate hits 1.9

HAL Excluded: Defence Ministry Picks Private Firms for AMCA Prototypes

RK Singh, India's Defence Secretary, stated at NDTV's Defence Conclave 2026 that the government

India to Buy 114 Rafales for Rs 3.25 Lakh Crore Amid Tejas Delays

Supreme Court takes action on Delhi's gang-rape cases, echoes 2012 Nirbhaya failures

China Claims It Has Cut Troops At The Border. But The Reality Is More Complex

S&P Global Ratings Raises India's GDP Growth Projections To 7% For This Fiscal

HAL shares rise 2% as firm hands over 3 aerospace platforms to IAF. What is Goldman Sachs saying?

Indian PM Urges Industry: "Skill and Innovate" at Semicon India 2026

EPFO Wage Ceiling Hiked to ₹25,000, Covering 51 Lakh More Workers

The rescue of five baby orangutans from the Bichitrapur forest in Odisha's

20 million children globally face online sexual abuse, UNICEF reports

The World Meteorological Organization issued a forecast on Thursday predicting a nearly

Mains questions to practise

GS2 • INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

Discuss the significance of the 'Global South' concept in contemporary multilateralism and India's role in shaping the agenda of the BRICS bloc.

USE : [multilateralism](#) [Global South](#) [strategic autonomy](#) [de-escalation](#) [collective security](#)

GS2 • INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

Discuss the significance of BRICS in elevating the influence of the Global South and its role in reshaping the current global economic order.

USE : [Global South](#) [Multipolarity](#) [Economic Diplomacy](#) [Emerging Economies](#) [Bloc Cohesion](#)

GS3 • SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

Discuss the significance of achieving imaging capabilities in Geosynchronous orbit for India's space-based surveillance and disaster management capabilities.

USE : [Geosynchronous orbit](#) [Earth observation](#) [Space-based surveillance](#) [Strategic autonomy](#)

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